AIIMS Patna Sarthi — Pilot Proposal

A four-week, no-cost pilot in one AIIMS Patna OPD department

Digital Health & AI in Healthcare | No diagnostic claim | No real patient data collected | 24 October 2026

1. Objective

To test, in one real OPD department and at no cost to the hospital, whether giving patients the app reduces the time they lose finding their way, their token and their report — and whether it reduces the number of direction and status questions asked at counters.

2. What we propose

Scope

- **One** OPD department, to be chosen by AIIMS
- **Four weeks**, Monday to Saturday, OPD hours
- The app only — no device, no consumable, no new equipment
- Free for patients and for the hospital
- Patients take part only if they choose to

What we put in place

- QR posters at the department entrance, registration counter and lift lobby
- A short briefing for counter and nursing staff (15 minutes)
- One nodal person from our side on site during OPD hours
- Weekly written feedback to the department head

3. How the four weeks run

Stage	Activity
Week 0	Written permission from the department and, where required, the institutional ethics committee. Staff briefing. Posters installed. Baseline numbers noted (average time to locate the department, average counter queries).
Weeks 1–4	Pilot live during OPD hours. Daily log of issues. Weekly review with the nodal officer from the department.
Week 5	Consolidated report submitted to the department and to APIIC: what improved, what did not, and what we will change.

4. What we will measure

Measure	How
Time taken by a first-time patient to reach the right department	Short anonymous exit question at the counter
Number of direction / status questions asked at the counter	Staff tally sheet, before and during the pilot
Token confusion (patients missing their turn)	Staff tally sheet
Report collection — repeat visits per report	Counter tally sheet
Patient feedback	Anonymous 3-question slip (optional)
Staff feedback	Short structured discussion at the end of the pilot

5. Data, privacy and ethics

No real patient data is collected or stored.

- The app stores nothing on any server. Anything a user enters stays on that user's own phone.
- No name, no UHID, no Aadhaar, no report and no diagnosis is taken from any patient for this pilot.
- The only data we collect is **anonymous counters** (e.g. "time taken: 6 minutes") and optional anonymous feedback slips — no identifier of any kind.
- If the department requires it, we will not start until written ethics clearance is in place.
- Patients are told plainly that the app gives general information only and is not a diagnosis or a substitute for a doctor.

6. What we need from AIIMS Patna

- Permission to run the pilot in **one** OPD department, and a **nodal officer** to coordinate.
- Approval to put up **four QR posters** in that department.
- Ethics committee guidance — and clearance if the committee considers it necessary.
- A 15-minute slot in a staff meeting for the briefing.

7. What we provide

- The app, free of cost, in Hindi, English, Bhojpuri and Maithili, working offline after the first open.
- All printing (posters and slips), all training, and one person on site during OPD hours.
- Weekly and final written reports, including the numbers that did *not* improve.
- Full removal of all material at the end of the pilot if the department wishes.

8. Success criteria

- At least **60%** of patients who open the app find their department without asking at a counter.
- A measurable fall in direction and status questions at the counter during the pilot weeks.
- No patient-safety incident, and no complaint about the app or the posters.
- A positive or constructive written view from the department head.

9. Regulatory position

- The app is a **navigation and OPD workflow tool**. It does not diagnose, prescribe, monitor or predict any disease, and we make no diagnostic claim.
- The AI features give **general health information only**, and say so on every answer.
- This pilot involves **no medical device and no consumable**. The Phase 2 consumable is a separate proposal, and its classification will be confirmed by CDSCO before any manufacture or use.

10. Why start here

AIIMS Patna is where the problem is visible every morning. A four-week, no-cost pilot in one department produces something no slide can: real numbers and real patient feedback. Those numbers become the evidence base for the Phase 2 consumable, for BIRAC and DST applications, and for taking the app to other government hospitals in Bihar.

Abhinav Kumar
Mobile: +91 7903083597 / +91 8864097706
Email: sanjaykumarpathak1377@gmail.com
Live app: abhinavpathak4120.github.io/aiims-patna-sarthi